

Simple Subjects and Simple Predicates

The homework half of the lesson. Circle the one word that runs each half, then strip a sentence down to two.

Name _____ Date _____

PART A — ONE WORD _____ / 6

Circle the single word the question asks for. Describing words are never the answer, however close to the verb they sit.

1.

The tall antenna behind the office sways in the wind.

simple subject
2.

A student pilot in the first plane taxis toward the numbers.

simple predicate
3.

The green fuel drum beside the shed leaks a little.

simple subject
4.

Two visitors near the gate photograph the yellow biplane.

simple predicate
5.

A folding chair under the wing holds somebody's coffee.

simple subject
6.

The mechanic's daughter counts the planes on the ramp.

simple predicate

PART B — DOWN TO TWO WORDS _____ / 5

Write the simple subject and the simple predicate for each sentence. Then read those two words on their own and check that they still make sense together.

1. The oldest plane on the field starts on the second try.

Simple subject

Simple predicate

2. A row of orange cones marks the edge of the apron.

Simple subject

Simple predicate

3. The chief mechanic's radio crackles all morning.

Simple subject

Simple predicate

4. Two dogs behind the fuel shed bark at every engine.

Simple subject

Simple predicate

5. A thin line of cloud hides the far end of the runway.

Simple subject

Simple predicate

PART C — WRITE YOUR OWN

_____ / 2

Write a sentence of your own on the first line, then write its two words underneath.

1. A sentence about anything you like

Its two words

2. A longer sentence, with a phrase in the middle

Its two words

Total _____ / **13**

Graded by _____

Notes _____

ANSWER KEY

Part A — the word that should be circled.

1. antenna
2. taxis
3. drum
4. photograph
5. chair
6. counts

Part B — subject, then predicate.

1. plane · starts
2. row · marks
3. radio · crackles
4. dogs · bark
5. line · hides

Part C — answers vary. The simple subject should be one noun or pronoun, never a describing word beside it, and the simple predicate should be the verb. If the two words he writes do not make sense read on their own, he has picked out of the describing phrase.

Say the sentence with only those two words. If it still stands up on its own, you found them.